Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Senior Operator

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Adam

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Coordinate operators to deal with issues
- Ensure wastewater is getting treated to appropriate levels
- Writing SOPs on how to do things
- Coordinating with maintenance and contractors
- Determine how/when to shut off parts of plant for construction & maintenance
- Log people
- Check alarms and ensure plang is running
- Walk around plant to check

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Critical thinking
- Change direction quickly
- Think outside the box
- React quickly
- Understanding piping and water flow

Hardest Part

- Unconventional hours
  - Senior = be able to be on swing and nights
  - Wed-Sat or Sun-Wed
- Needing to be able to respond all the time

Necessary Background

- Passion
- Experience and courses
- Troubleshooting, how you overcame a situation
- Be able to work and get along with others
- Safety

Security against AI

- Very secure right now, because physical component
- AI would have to be able to repair itself, and you would still need backup anyway
- Stairs, uneven terrain, and situations that robots can't deal with

Advice for Students

Take college courses (wastewater, pumps and motors, courses are cool). Volunteer or intern to start gaining hours.

Recommended Education

Background in wastewater-related subjects helpful; experience

Average Salary

$82,046

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Senior Mechanic

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Will Swalve

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- General maintenance, reparing pumping systems, construction, anything issued on the work order
- Documents materials and project plans
- Writing work plans
- Investigate equipment failures
- Lead maintenance projects

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Understanding of tools
- Safety
- Being able to listen

Hardest Part

- Change

Necessary Background

- Mechanical aptitude
- Something to prove that you can be counted on

Security against AI

- Very secure against AI. Machines break down and you would need to have robots who can fix machines and themselves

Advice for Students

Be on time. Get everything set up before your job starts.

Recommended Education

Experience

Average Salary

$82,855

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Environmental Compliance Specialist

Technical Services Dept.



SVCW Employee: Mark Swenson

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Inspect (external) places to ensure they follow environmental regulations and rules
- Follow up with them to ensure issue is addressed
- Talking to people at sites and evaluating sites
- Finding and removing source of different pollution
- Reports and paperwork from inspections

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Be self-directed

Hardest Part

- Many problems are recurring but at different places, and can get tiring to deal with
- Have to figure out how to give feedback to different people

Necessary Background

- Worked with different people and groups of people
- Internal and external collaboration
- Good sense of how to connect with the public

Security against AI

- One of the most secure jobs
- Certain parts could be taken over, but that's similar to any job on the market

Advice for Students

Look into water quality oriented classes/classwork. Don't get discouraged because it's difficult.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's in biology, chemistry, or environment

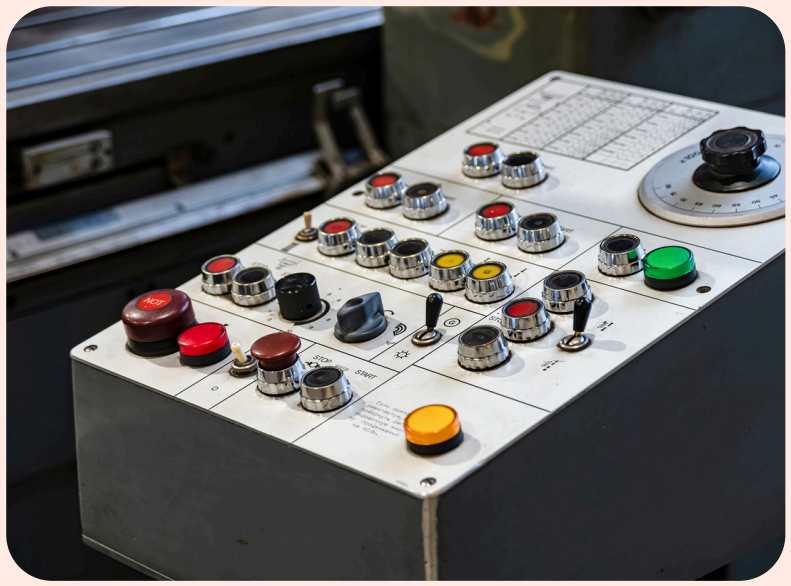
Average Salary

$85,426

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Chief Operating Officer



Senior Management

Operations & Management Dept.

SVCW Employee: Danny Buenrostro

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Planning, coaching, talking
- Filling reports
- Oversee everyone in operations/maintenance
- Coordinate, manage, organize, review people
- Maintain compliance with operations/maintenance staff
- Present to Commissions/Boards

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Strategic planning

Hardest Part

- Difficult conversations

Necessary Background

- Used tools
- Built/repaired something
- Troubleshooting and problem solving skills
- Teamwork

Security against AI

- Not all wastewater plants are automatic, you still need in person people to go and turn valves, move trucks, etc
- Positions in far future would change, not completely be overtaken

Advice for Students

If you like to work with your hands and don't mind getting dirty, this is a great career opportunity.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's in wastewater re field helpful; experience

Average Salary

$315,448

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Marketing/ Outreach

Business Services Dept



SVCW Employee: Maevis Sanders

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Design work for website and social media
- Administrative assisting (early in career)
- Meetings with teams and other departments
- Plan for projects
- Cross-functional coordination

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Flexibility

Necessary Background

- Be enthusiastic

Hardest Part

- Being on the same page as teammates, if in a remote position.
- Understanding the different industries and dfferent audiences. Who is the audience for a wastewater facility, and what does that mean?
- Translating standard business school model into one that works for the public sector.

Security against AI

- AI is unfortunately more of a concerin in marketing.
- AI is primarily coming into marketing reearch through data analysis and finding human behavior patterns.
- There will always need to be human, though, to interpret the results in a human way.

Advice for Students

Flexibility and creativity are very important. The guidelines learned in school are not built for the public works. The frameworks are not the foundation; your curiosity is. Learn to use Microsoft tools.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's in marketing/business

Average Salary

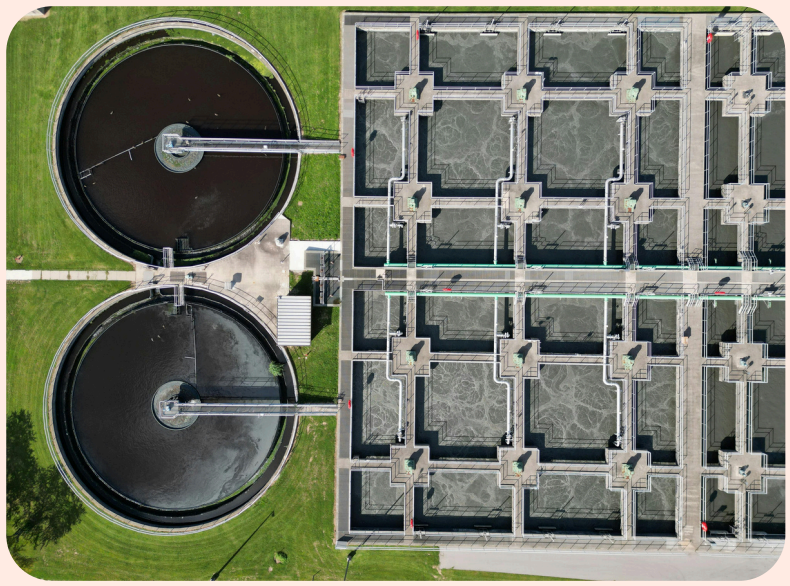
$78,760

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Authority/ General Manager

★ Senior Management



SVCW Employee: Matt Zucca

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Long term planning
- Report to the commission
- Emailing
- Meeting and talking with staff
- Writing and reviewing staff reports
- Meeting with consulting about projects
- Reflecting on how things are going and what needs to be changed
- Conversations with other city managers and staff
- Leader of plant

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Strategic thinking
- Problem solving
- Articulate and explain complex thoughts on a level simplified enough for non-technical people to understand

Hardest Part

- At higher management, you do less specific work and instead manage the execution of work through people and then through layers of people
- Keeping balance between exerting a presence without being overbearing

Necessary Background

- How do you think?
- How do you approach life?
- Technical skills/studies
- Critical thinking

Security against AI

- AI can be helpful for routine administrative work, but
- This job is far too relationship based in order for AI to take over at all anytime soon

Advice for Students

Focus on something and pursue something, because you always have another opportunity. You don't have to figure out everything at 16 years old. Try internships, advance technical and thinking skills. Keep trying. It's a fun career. Learning comes from a challenge, so take challenges.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's in any wastewater-related field helpful; primarily experience in wastewater leadership

Average Salary

No exact data; estimated $200-300k+

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Lab Director

Management

Technical Services Dept.



SVCW Employee: Tiffany Ishaya

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Scheduling, coordinating, and communicating
- Problem solving
- Monitor the treatment process by collecting and analyzing samples, throughout the process
- Ensure plant is meeting compliance standards
- Prepare/review lab reports
- Oversees lab

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Critical thinking
- Adaptability
- Organizational skills
- Education in science/chemistry

Hardest Part

- Being adaptable and dealing with unexpected problems

Necessary Background

- Science (biology, chemistry, environemntal)
- Collaboration and teamwork
- Being detail oriented

Security against AI

- AI could take more of the online meters rather than field work to collect samples
- But you would still need someone to verifty everything

Advice for Students

Visit California Water Environemtn Association (CWEA) for resources, events, and internships. Network by volunteering and taking tours. Ask questions. Some community colleges, such as Sacramento, offers courses in the industry.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's in chemistry, biology, bacteriology, or related field

Average Salary

$171,682

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Maintenance Supervisor

Management

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Sean Rodriguez

How Collaborative?



Collaborative — Individual

Work Type



Physical — Mental

Job Structure



In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Set the crew up with their tasks for the day
- Emails, schedules, planning, creating time cards
- Research on manuals for parts and equipment
- Checking progress/updates
- Maintaining records

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Motivation
- You have to care about the people working with/under you

Hardest Part

- Dealing with people
- You can't manage emotions and personalities

Necessary Background

- Teamwork and succeeding in a team environment
- Good attitude

Security against AI

- Helpful for being more organized and other tools
- AI however cannot assist or manage equipment at this level of scrutiny
- AI cannot look at the bigger picture instead of just one system
- AI also cannot lead people

Advice for Students

Be collaborative, have a good attitude, learn to follow. Don't be so quick to be a leader and worry about being in charge.

Recommended Education

Experience in maintenance for wastewater or industrial

Average Salary

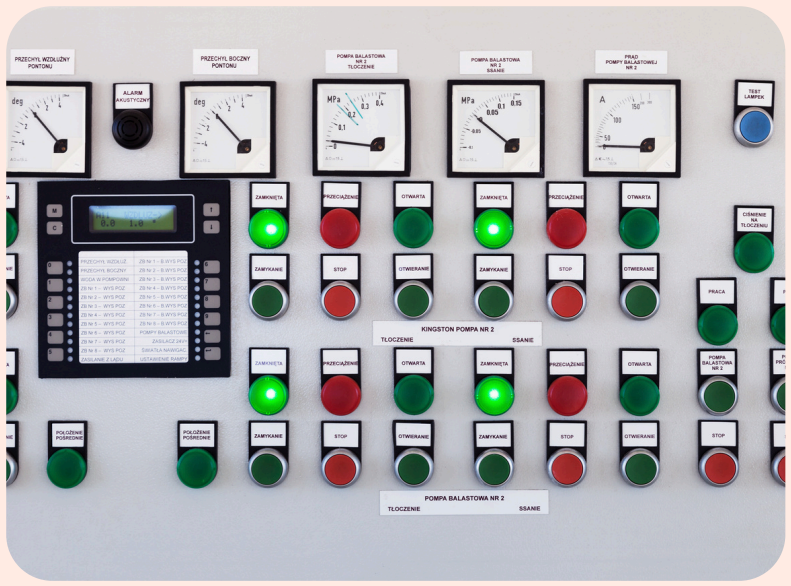
$83,900

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Operater

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Angelo

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Creating/maintaining automations
- Operate equipment
- Clean and perform routine maintenance of plant
- Inspect equipment
- Receive and store items (including chemicals)
- Test water samples

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Being able to learn new things

Hardest Part

- Working with people

Necessary Background

- Ability to think out of the box
- Self-driven
- Curiosity and asking questions
- Good attitude

Security against AI

- Can help, but can't replace humans
- It doesn't always understand things, and has a rough time thinking out-of-the-box
- You still need someone who unrstands the system

Advice for Students

Learning as much as you can. Be curious; people want to give curious people opportunities. Find a mentor, if you can. You don't need to know a job to get a job; you just need to show that you can learn.

Recommended Education

Related experience, minor chemistry/biology knowledge

Average Salary

$60,020

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Electrician

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Chris Leon

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Comb the work quarter to look for upcoming tasks
- Perform routine maintenance, installation, repair work, and troubleshooting for electrical related things around the plant
- Keep up on and track with stock items
- Further skills

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Being creative
- Troubleshooting

Hardest Part

- Working with people
- People on their worst days, people who are confused

Necessary Background

- Willingness to learn
- Projects you've taken on / evidence of tinkering or working / hobbies
- Good attitude

Security against AI

- People don't trust it over human decision yet
- Could be there for guidance, but cybersecurity and privacy are still big issues
- Work is too intricate for robots and AI so far
- Somimes you also need to feed AI documentation, which may not be updated or exist at all

Advice for Students

Get experience and appy for jobs, even if you don't think y are a fit for the job. Even if they say no, you get experience. Sometimes you're not going to have the answer, so you need to know when to ask for help.

Recommended Education

Experience as an electrician apprentice can be helpful

Average Salary

$63,190

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Authority Engineer

Senior Management

Technical Services Dept.



SVCW Employee: Kim Hackett

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Checking in and mentoring staff members
- 3-4 meetings with staff
- Responding to emails
- Coordinating staff
- Overseeing and participating in difficult or longer-term engineering projects
- Present items to commission

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Discernment and logical approach to solving problems
- Ability to collaborate and work with others
- Figuring out how to define and then solve the problem

Hardest Part

- Dealing with unexpected changes
- Figuring out how to help a lot of different people work together

Necessary Background

- Education
- Engineer = civil or mechanical
- Interest in career
- Experience within the wastewater field

Security against AI

- AI can help with certain technical challenges and design issues
- But it takes judgement and people's priorities, and AI cannot replace that

Advice for Students

Look for internships and opportunities. Having a fulfilling career is incredibly important.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's Degree in Engineering (civil, environmental, or mechanical)

Average Salary

$119,422

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Procurement Specialist

Business Services Dept



SVCW Employee: Sylvia Alejos

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Purchasing items for every department in the organization
- Examples: computers, monitors, valves, pumps, car/truck maintenance items
- Preparing purchasing documents
- Working with internal customers and outside vendors

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Productivity
- Challenge yourself
- Communication
- Troubleshooting
- Problem solving

Hardest Part

- How to communicate well with others
- Creating rapport with others

Necessary Background

- Skills of what you can do and have accomplishes so far
- How you present yourself
- How you can engage and bring people into conversation

Advice for Students

Get an education and develop your people skills. Keep learning and figure out how to deal with other people as well. Try things out, try different things, and challenge yourself.

Recommended Education

College level courses/certificates, or BS/AS in appropriate subjects

Average Salary

$92,522

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Chief Financial Officer



Senior Management

Business Services Dept

SVCW Employee: Matt Anderson

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Depends on the day
- Examples:
  - Payroll
  - Accounts payable (invoices, contractors, etc)
- Risk management (insurance, etc)
- Procurement (purchasing items, requisitions, processing POs, etc)
- Managing financial projects
- Meetings, planning

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Technical skills of accounting and finance
- Organization
- Project management
- Ability to manage people, connect ideas, and ensure progress

Hardest Part

- Dealing with unpredictable conditions

Security against AI

- AI makes parts of the job faster or more efficient
- AI will not take over jobs, most likely; you do need to learn to use AI for jobs because it will be a skill that determines if you get a job or not

Advice for Students

Business/finance/economy majors are helpful, but a lot of unrelated majors are good. Invest time into what you are good at and enjoy, and build on it, and you can be successful in almost any career. Be yourself, apply yourself, and work hard. Be curious and ask questions.

Recommended Education

Bachelor's Degree in finance/economy/business

Average Salary

$240K–$380K

Awesome Web Browser

https://suhanibansal870.github.io/svcw-careers/

Maintenance Director

Management

Operations & Management Dept.



SVCW Employee: Sameet Shankar

How Collaborative?

Collaborative — Individual

Work Type

Physical — Mental

Job Structure

In Person — Hybrid — Remote

Day-to-day Tasks

- Come in at 6am
- Respond to emails
- Meetings with staff
- Coordinate and supervise planning/scheduling/review of staff and equipment
- Manage projects and programs
- Manage budget
- Complete general tasks as needed

Necessary Skill or Trait

- Patience
- Ability to listen
- Gathering all facts to make decisions

Hardest Part

- Communicating with all of your staff in the best way that works for them
- Understanding your staff

Reccomended Background

- Able to learn
- Motivated to explore out of comfort zone
- Know why you want to go into this field
- Adaptable
- Not afraid to bring feedback to make things better

Advice for Students

Look into this field and its careers. Take a tour, explore the fields. No one can take away your knowlege, so learn to be a sponge and explore trade skills if you are interested.

Recommended Education

Recommended: Associate's Degree - Trades or sciences

Required: Experience in field

Average Salary

No exact data; estimated $100-200k+

Collections of Wisdom

Sameet Shankar: “The knowlege is something nobody can ever take away from me. So it’s learn to be a sponge and explore into this industry.”

Matt Anderson: “In our careers, we kind of respond to the conditions where we’re met with, and we do our best to make the right decision, and we grow from there.”

Sylvia Alejos: “If you become more personable, people will help you a lot more.” / “I wish I knew I culd do more than what thought I could.”

Chris Leon: “I’d say the most important thing is to keep trying, being persistent, because you never know what you’re going to get into. I mean, even if you don’t like it at first, maybe you'll learn some stuff that you could use in another job.” / “Sometimes you're not going to have the answer to what you need to accomplish and knowing when to ask for help [is incredibly important].”

Angelo: "Always be curious. The more curious you are, the more you’re going to end up having people that are going to want to feed that curiosity.”

Sean Rodriguez: “It’s whatever you want to put into it, is what you’re going to get out of it.” / “You can’t motivate people. You can inspire people [though].” / “You still learn a lot from bad leaders, too. Not just the good leads. You learn a lot about the qualities of bad leaders, and you take all the good and the bad, and hopefully you can form something that you can be a little better at.” / “You can teach anybody anything, you know? If you made it that far to an interview, it means you’re pretty much qualified for the job. Now we’re just going to gauge your personality towards how this [job] is going to work."

Matt Zucca: "At the end of the day, what we talk about here is that we learn when we’re uncomfortable, and we learn from our mistakes...And so the main thing is to just keep pushing at it and keep trying.”

Danny Buenrostro: “You're always ging to teach someone and you’re just continuing to keep this industry afloat.”

Will Swalve: “You have to be able to problem solve on your own, but it takes a village; the experience of the other mechanics is very helpful. We help each other.”

Adam: “It’s such a fun and awesome field. I enjoy it quite a bit.”

Sources

General Sources
Wastewater Careers Resource (Interview home)
SVCW Org Chart
Consolidated Pay Schedule | SVCW
HR Documents | SVCW

Maintenance Director
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Interview with Sylvia Alejos
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Laboratory-Director Job Description | SVCW
Lab Director Salary | Salary.com

Authority/General Manager
Interview with Matt Zucca
Manager Job Description | SVCW

Marketing/Outreach
Interview with Maevis Sanders
Marketing Research Analysts and Marketing Specialists | O*NET Online

Chief Operating Officer
Interview with Danny Buenrostro
Chief Operating Officer Job Description | SVCW
Chief Operating Officer Salary | Salary.com

Environmental Compliance Specialist
Interview with Mark Swenson
Environmental Compliance Specialist Job Description | SVCW
Environmental Compliance Specialist Salary | Salary.com

Senior Mechanic
Interview with Will Swalve
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Senior Mechanic Salary | Salary.com

Senior Operator
Interview with Adam
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Senior Operator Salary | GlassDoor